



**Lone act:** The second-fastest T20 hundred at the time, a 37-ball blitz from Yusuf Pathan that mixed finesse with fury, still wasn't enough as a limp Rajasthan Royals batting effort handed Mumbai Indians a four-run win. THE HINDU PHOTO LIBRARY

come in the last four seasons alone.

The trend has peaked in 2026, with nearly half the hundreds ending in defeats (six out of 13). It also aligns with the broader rise of high-scoring matches, where even a massive individual score, such as KL Rahul's 152\* against Punjab Kings, is no longer a guarantee of victory.

### Innings difference

There is a huge variance in the win factor between first-innings and second-innings hundreds in the IPL.

Scoring a hundred while chasing almost guarantees victory, with an 89.2% win rate.

There have only been four instances of a player scoring a

century in the second innings and still ending up on the losing side (see Table 1, below).

Even this rarity has become more frequent in recent years. In the first 13 seasons, there was just one losing hundred in a chase, Pathan's ton against MI. But this decade alone has already produced three such instances.

In contrast, the win rate for a first-innings hundred is just 65.9%. This suggests that without the context of a target, there is a greater probability of a century proving too slow and, potentially, match-losing.

### Strike-rate correlation

The average strike rate for winning centuries (197.8), compared to losing ones (190.0), indicates that the pace of a hundred is often a decisive factor in the outcome of a game.

Scoring a century at a strike rate below 160 and still winning is relatively rare in the IPL, having happened only five times in the tournament's history.

The last such instance came in 2023, when Virat Kohli's 63-ball hundred helped RCB beat SRH.

### The 180 SR 'inflection point'

A strike rate of 180 appears to be the critical threshold for win probability in IPL hundreds. Hundreds scored below that mark have produced only a 67.4% win rate. But once the strike rate crosses 180, the win percentage jumps significantly to above 73%, and continues to rise thereafter.

There have only been five losing hundreds scored at a strike rate of 220 or more.

The most recent, and the quickest among them, came this season from Rajasthan Royals' Vaibhav Sooryavanshi, who smashed 103 off 37 balls against Sunrisers Hyderabad (see Table 2, facing page).

TABLE 1

| Player          | Team             | Score | Against             | Date           |
|-----------------|------------------|-------|---------------------|----------------|
| Yusuf Pathan    | Rajasthan Royals | 100   | Mumbai Indians      | March 13, 2010 |
| Sanju Samson    | Rajasthan Royals | 119   | Punjab Kings        | April 12, 2021 |
| Rohit Sharma    | Mumbai Indians   | 105*  | Chennai Super Kings | April 14, 2024 |
| Cooper Connolly | Punjab Kings     | 107*  | Sunrisers Hyderabad | May 6, 2026    |